Table 22.5 National Parks in Tamil Nadu

Name	District	Established year
Guindy National Park	Chennai	1976
Gulf of Mannar National Park	Ramanathapuram	1980
Indira Gandhi National Park	Coimbatore	1989
Mudumalai National Park	The Nilgiris	1990
Mukurthi National Park	The Nilgiris	1990

b. Wildlife sanctuaries

Sanctuary is a protected area which is reserved for the conservation of animals only. Human activities like harvesting of timber, collection of forest products and private ownership rights are allowed here. Controlled interference like tourist activity is also allowed. The differences between national parks and wildlife sanctuaries are given in Table 22.6

Table 22.6 Wildlife Sanctuaries in Tamil Nadu

Name	District	Established year
Meghamalai Wildlife Sanctuary	Theni	2016
Vandaloor Wildlife Sanctuary	Chennai	1991
Kalakad Wildlife Sanctuary	Thirunelveli	1976
Grizzled Squirrel Wildlife Sanctuary	Virudhunagar	1988
Vedanthangal Wildlife Sanctuary	Kanchipuram	1936



Figure 22.10 Vedanthangal wildlife sanctuary

Table 22.7 Difference between National Parks and Wildlife Sanctuaries

Wildlife Sanctuary	National Parks
Human activities are allowed.	No human activities are allowed.
Main aim is to protect a particular flora or fauna.	Flora, fauna or any other objects of historical significance are protected.
There are no fixed boundaries.	Boundaries are fixed and defined.
It is open to the general public	Not usually open to the public.
Sanctuaries are usually formed by the order of central or the state government	National Parks are formed by the state or central legislature.
A sanctuary can be upgraded to a national park	A national park cannot be downgraded to a sanctuary.

c. Biosphere reserves

Biosphere is a protected area where human population also forms the part of the system. The area of these places will be around 5000 square kilometers. They conserve the eco system, species and genetic resources. These areas are set up mainly for economic development.

Table 22.8 Biosphere Reserves in India

Name of Biosphere	State / Union Territory
Nanda Devi	Uttar Pradesh
Nokrek	Meghalaya
Manas	Assam
Sunderbans	West Bengal
Gulf of Mannar	Tamil Nadu
Nilgiri	Tamil Nadu
Great Nicobars and Similipal	Andaman and Nicobar / Orissa

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